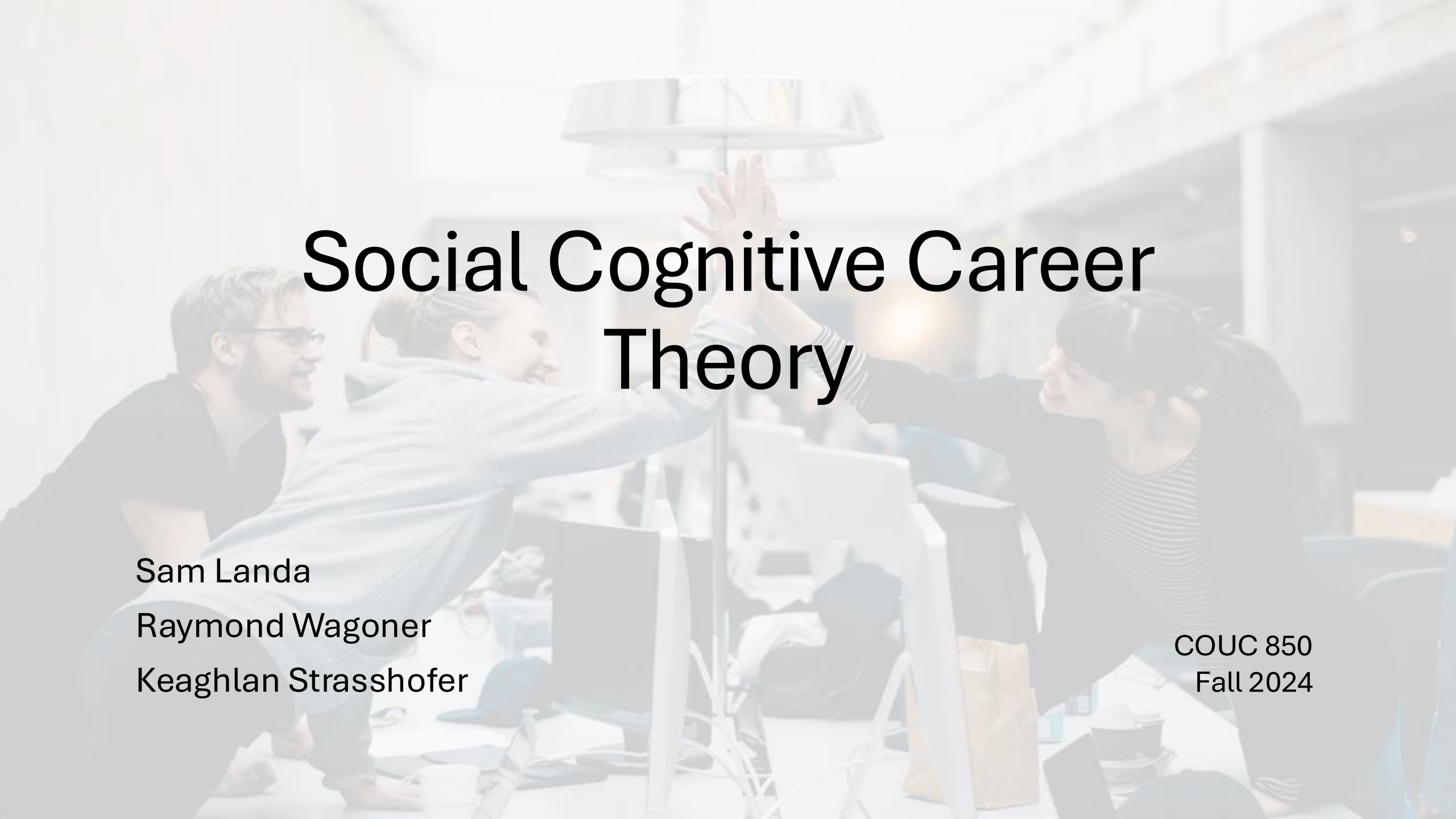


A background image showing three people in a modern office setting. A man on the left, a woman in the center, and another woman on the right are all smiling and high-fiving each other. They are standing around a desk with computer monitors. The office has large windows and modern lighting.

Social Cognitive Career Theory

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What is SCCT?

Learning Environment

Self-efficacy

Outcome Expectations

Interests

Career Decision Making

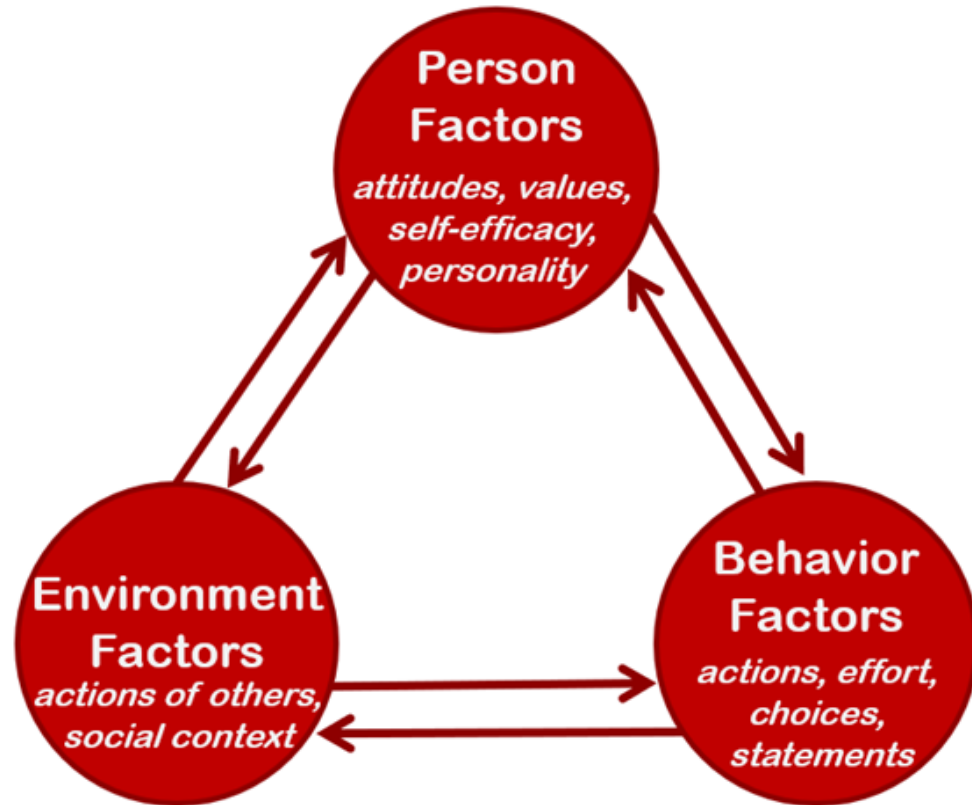




Foundations of SCCT

- Less concerned with ages and stages
- More concerned with theoretical elements of career behavior across developmental tasks

Bandura's Triadic Reciprocal Model



Based on Bandura (1977).

- This reciprocal relationship shapes the person, environment, and behavior
- This feedback loop is constantly re-occurring.

Learning Environment

What is a learning environment?

- A physical, emotional, and psychological landscape in which you are constantly interacting with
- This is uniquely experienced by every person



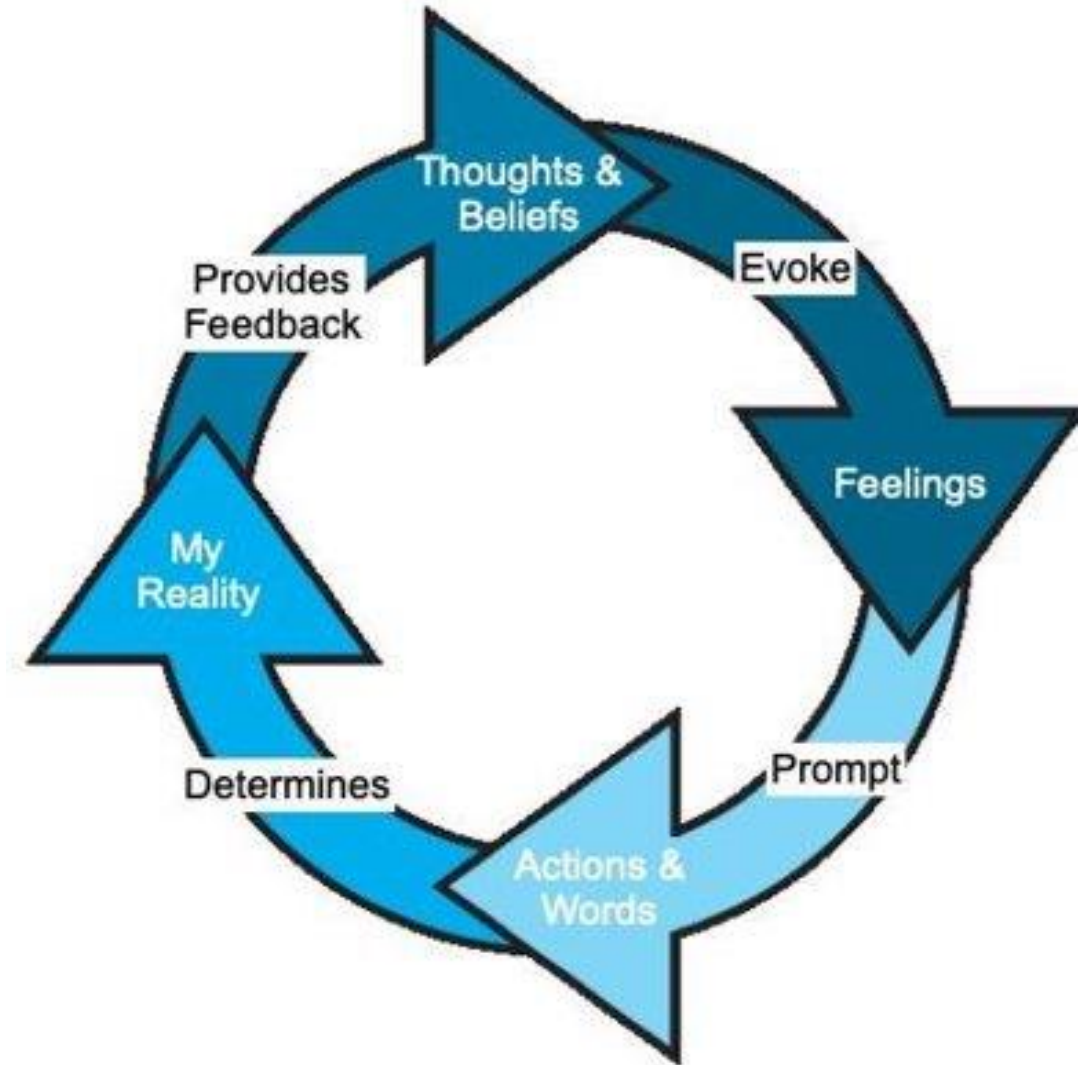
Learning Environment

We are constantly evolving and learning

We are always experiencing thoughts and feelings which lead to words and actions

We create feedback loops from the constant interactions between our experiences and learning opportunities

The Conscious Person's
Divine Creative Process
(with Feedback Loop)



Feedback Loop

Learning Environment

What can influence a learning environment?

- Culture
- Ethnicity
- Gender
- Genetic endowment
- Health & Disability status
- Socioeconomic Conditions



What
Emerges
from Our
Learning
Experiences?

Can I do it?



What will
happen if I do
it?

Bandura defines self-efficacy as
"people's ***judgments*** of their
capabilities to ***organize*** and ***execute***
courses of ***action required*** to attain
designated types of ***performances***"
(1986, p. 391).

Self-Efficacy

- These beliefs answer the question "Can I perform this task?" Or "Do I have the abilities needed?"
- Happens through an unconscious awareness.





Self-Efficacy

- Evaluations re-occurring on an unconscious level
 - Can I pass this class?
 - Am I good at this subject?
 - Can I accomplish this task?
- These beliefs are formed at an early age within the context of the learning environment and continuously form.
- 4 main influencers of self-efficacy

1. Personal Performance Accomplishment

- Have I been able to do this skill?
- Do I have the ability?
- How have I performed in the past?
- This is the ***strongest*** influencer.





2. Vicarious Learning

- What/Who do I see?
- Do I see others like me doing this?
- Lack of representation (gender, ethnicity, etc.) impacts self-efficacy beliefs

3. Social Persuasion

- "You can do it!"
- "You have the skills needed!"
- "I see potential in you"
- ***Not as effective*** at changing self-efficacy



4. Physiological States and Reactions

- "fight/flight/freeze"
- I.e. someone having a "weak stomach" going into the nursing field
- Can these states/reactions be overcome?



Feedback Loop

- Successes or failures support either positive or negative self-efficacy beliefs
- Self-efficacy informs interests since people pursue tasks they think they are capable of
- This feedback loop not only informs our self-efficacy beliefs, but also our outcomes expectations





Outcome Expectations

- Self-efficacy influences outcome expectations by increasing the odds that the action will be purposeful or meaningful (Lent et al., 2008)
- Beliefs about results of certain behaviors.
 - "The imagined consequences of engaging in a course of action" (Bandura, 1986)
 - What will happen if I change my major in my Junior year?
 - Beliefs about results or consequences change our desire to engage in the behavior

Outcome Expectations

- Include our beliefs about (If I engage in this behavior, it will result in...)
 - Extrinsic reinforcement
 - Tangible rewards
 - Self-directed consequences
 - Motivational success or failure
 - Process-oriented
 - Education
 - Internship
 - Apprenticeship





Outcome Expectations

- 3 primary areas
 - Physical – pleasant vs painful
 - Social – approval vs disapproval
 - Individual insights – self-satisfaction vs self-criticism

(Deacon, 2011)



Outcome Expectations

- Less influential on behavior than self-efficacy (Lent et al., 2008)
 - I could see myself being a lawyer, but I'm not good enough, so I will fail if I try.
- What we imagine will happen if we perform certain behaviors is still influential.
 - I know I would make a good lawyer, but I don't imagine I would enjoy it.

Outcome Expectations

- How does this affect interests?
 - If I imagine a positive outcome, I can build interest in it.
 - If being a designer sounds fun to me because I believe I can be good at it, I can be interested in being a designer.

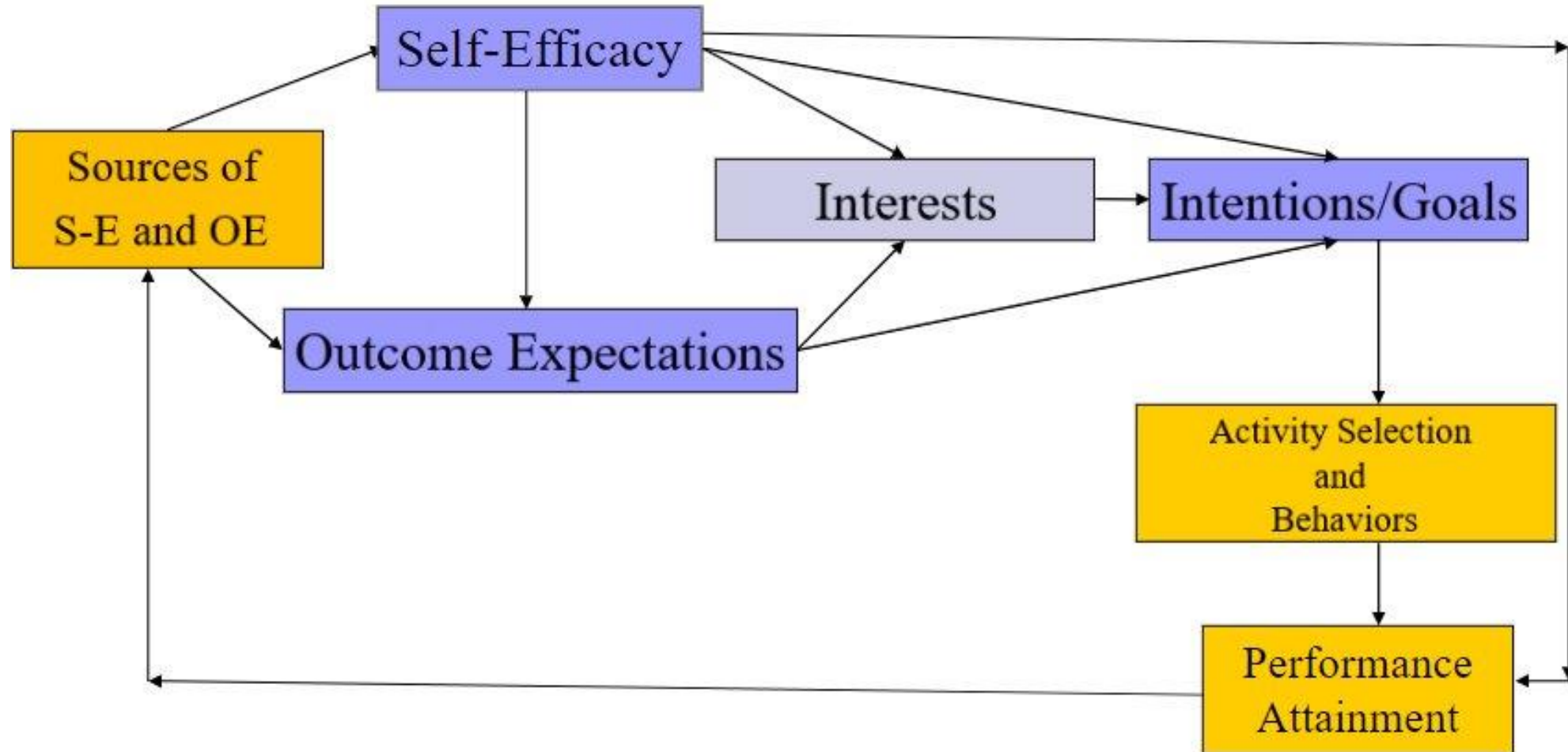


Interests

- Do I want it?
- Influenced by self-efficacy and outcomes expectations
- If I think I'm good at it and I like how it could turn out, I'm interested.
- Drives the motivation to set goals and change behaviors



SCCT Model Summary



Finishing our PhD

PhD Student



What my friends think I do



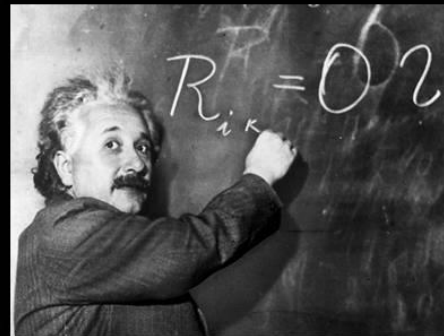
What my parents think I do



What society thinks I do



What my boss thinks I do



What I think I do



What I actually do

References

Bandura, A. (1986). *Social foundations of thought and action: A social cognitive theory*. Prentice Hall.

Lent, R. W., Sheu, H.-B., Singley, D., Schmidt, J. A., Schmidt, L. C., & Gloster, C. S. (2008). Longitudinal relations of self-efficacy to outcome expectations, interests, and major choice goals in engineering students. *Journal of Vocational Behavior.*, 73(2), 328–335.
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